RIVYLS

Fantasy Sports, Reimagined.

BUSINESS PLAN

February 2026

CONFIDENTIAL

Prepared by:

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1. Executive Summary

Rivyls is a fantasy sports platform that fundamentally reimagines how fans engage with college athletics. Unlike traditional fantasy sports platforms where users draft individual players and track personal statistics, Rivyls users draft entire college programs and earn points based on team-level outcomes: wins, conference championships, ranked victories, bowl appearances, and playoff runs. This team-based approach transforms passive fans into strategic coaches making program-level decisions throughout the season.

The concept was validated during the 2025 college football season through a minimum viable product built on Google Sheets, serving 2 leagues with approximately 20 active users. User feedback confirmed strong engagement, high retention throughout the full season, and genuine enthusiasm for the program-drafting mechanic. A web platform is currently in development to support scalable growth for the 2026 season and beyond.

Market Opportunity: The global fantasy sports market is valued at approximately $31-38 billion in 2025 and is projected to grow at a 12-15% CAGR through 2033, reaching $67-105 billion. North America accounts for roughly 38% of global revenue. The U.S. alone has over 62 million fantasy sports participants, with football representing 74% of participation. Despite this massive market, no platform specializes in program-level college fantasy sports, representing a significant white-space opportunity.

Revenue Model: Rivyls will generate revenue through a freemium model combining free-to-play leagues (advertising-supported) with paid entry leagues (platform fee/rake), premium subscriptions for advanced analytics and commissioner tools, and strategic sponsorship partnerships with college sports media properties.

Growth Targets: Year 1 (2026-2027): 100 leagues, 1,000 users, validating acquisition and retention. Year 2 (2027-2028): 1,000 leagues, 10,000 users, launching NCAA basketball. Year 3 (2028-2029): 5,000+ leagues, 50,000+ users, multi-sport coverage with potential international expansion.

Funding: Rivyls is seeking $250,000-$500,000 in seed funding to accelerate web platform development, execute a targeted go-to-market strategy for the 2026 college football season, and hire key early staff. The founder is prepared to bootstrap to initial traction milestones if necessary.

2. Company Overview

Company Name	Rivyls
Legal Structure	*[To Be Determined: LLC or C-Corp recommended — C-Corp if seeking VC funding]*
State of Incorporation	*[To Be Determined — Delaware recommended for C-Corp]*
Headquarters	*[Your City, State]*
Founded	2025 (concept validation); 2026 (formal incorporation)
Website	*[rivyls.com or chosen domain]*
Industry	Fantasy Sports / Sports Technology / Digital Entertainment
Stage	Pre-seed / MVP validated
Founder	*[Your Name] — Founder, CEO, and Lead Developer*

Mission Statement

To become the definitive platform for program-level fantasy sports, giving fans a new way to experience college athletics by putting them in the role of strategic coach rather than statistical analyst.

Vision Statement

A world where every college sports fan has a deeper, more strategic connection to the programs they follow — where fandom is participatory, social, and rewarding.

Founder Background

The founder brings over 10 years of technology development and user experience expertise, combining deep technical knowledge with a passion for college sports. The Rivyls concept emerged from years of running informal college football pools, iterating on scoring systems, draft mechanics, and transaction rules to optimize engagement. The founder has single-handedly architected and built the MVP platform, including real-time ESPN API integration, multi-user authentication, automated scoring, snake draft systems, and weekly transaction processing.

[Add: Relevant education, prior startup experience, industry connections, advisory board members]

3. Market Analysis

Industry Overview

The fantasy sports industry is experiencing a period of sustained, rapid growth driven by increasing smartphone penetration, legalization momentum, real-time data availability, and the cultural shift toward interactive sports engagement. The global market is valued between $31-38 billion in 2025 depending on the research source, with projections ranging from $67 billion to $117 billion by 2033-2035, representing a compound annual growth rate of 12-15%.

North America remains the dominant market, accounting for approximately 38% of global fantasy sports revenue. The United States and Canada collectively had around 62.5 million fantasy sports participants in 2022, and that number has continued growing. Notably, 84 million adults in the U.S. and Canada joined fantasy sports or sports betting in the past year, indicating a rapidly expanding addressable market.

Mobile-first engagement now accounts for over 65% of all fantasy sports transactions, and that figure is growing at approximately 15% annually. This underscores the critical importance of a responsive, mobile-optimized web platform.

Competitive Landscape

The fantasy sports market has distinct tiers of competition. Understanding where Rivyls fits — and critically, where it does not directly compete — is essential to the go-to-market strategy.

Platform	Revenue	Users	Core Product	Draft Unit	Key Differentiator
DraftKings	$4.76B (2024)	~4.8M monthly	Salary cap DFS, sportsbook, casino	Individual player stats	Massive scale, brand recognition, marketing budget
FanDuel	$5.79B (2024)	~17M registered	DFS, sportsbook, FanDuel TV	Individual player stats	Owned by Flutter Entertainment; largest U.S. market share
PrizePicks	Leading DFS revenue share	82% MAU growth YoY	Pick'em (over/under on player stats)	Individual player stats	Fastest-growing DFS; operates in 45 states
Underdog Fantasy	Series B funded	35% MAU growth YoY	Best Ball, Pick'em, sportsbook	Individual player stats	Strong Best Ball product; $15M prize pools
Sleeper	Series C funded	39% MAU growth YoY	Season-long leagues, Pick'em	Individual player stats	Social-first; strong community features
ESPN/Yahoo Fantasy	Ad-supported	Tens of millions	Free season-long leagues	Individual player stats	Massive built-in audience; media integration

Critical Insight: Every major fantasy sports platform drafts individual players. No established platform offers program-level drafting as a core product. This is not an incremental improvement on existing products — it is a fundamentally different category of fantasy sports engagement. Rivyls does not compete for the same user intent as DraftKings or PrizePicks; it creates a new intent entirely.

Key Market Trends

1. Pick'em and simplified formats are outpacing traditional DFS. PrizePicks grew monthly active users 82% year-over-year in 2025. Simpler mechanics that reduce the research burden attract a broader audience, including casual fans who find salary-cap DFS intimidating.

2. Fantasy sports platforms are growing faster than sportsbooks. During the 2025 NFL season, fantasy platforms achieved 40% user growth and 106% revenue gains while sports betting apps saw 39% fewer installs.

3. Social and community features drive retention. Sleeper's rapid growth (39% MAU increase) is attributed to in-app chat, league communities, and social engagement tools.

4. College sports engagement is expanding. The CFP expansion to 12 teams, conference realignment, and NIL have generated unprecedented national interest in college athletics beyond traditional regional fanbases.

5. Regulatory environment favors skill-based fantasy. Fantasy sports enjoy broader legal access than sports betting, with operators like PrizePicks available in 45 states. Program-level drafting is squarely within the fantasy sports skill-game framework.

4. Target Customer Persona

Primary: The Commissioner

Demographics: Male, 25-40, college-educated, $50K-$100K income

The organizer in every friend group. Already runs a fantasy football league, a March Madness bracket pool, or a college football pick'em. Spends significant time on ESPN, Reddit's r/CFB, and college sports podcasts. This person is your most valuable user — acquiring one commissioner delivers 8-12 additional users through their league.

Pain Points: Tired of the same fantasy football format; wants something that leverages their deep college sports knowledge; values competition among friends over anonymous DFS contests.

Behavior: Active on social media, shares sports opinions, listens to 2-3 sports podcasts weekly, watches 3+ college football games per Saturday.

Secondary: The Casual College Fan

Demographics: Male or Female, 18-35, current or former college student

Has strong allegiance to their alma mater or a regional school. Watches college football on Saturdays but doesn't play traditional fantasy sports because it feels too complicated or time-consuming. Finds the concept of drafting schools/programs more intuitive and emotionally connected than tracking individual player stats.

Pain Points: Traditional fantasy feels like homework; wants a simpler way to make games more interesting; wants to leverage school loyalty and conference knowledge.

Behavior: Watches games socially (bars, watch parties), uses social media heavily, responds to friend invitations.

Tertiary: The Sports Bettor Looking for Variety

Demographics: Male, 21-45, active on DraftKings/FanDuel/PrizePicks

Already engaged in sports betting or DFS. Looking for new ways to engage with college sports beyond player props and point spreads. Attracted to season-long strategic decision-making rather than single-game wagers.

Pain Points: DFS fatigue; wants a format where strategy compounds over weeks rather than resetting daily; interested in a game where knowledge of programs, coaches, and recruiting matters more than player stat projections.

Behavior: High spending capacity, early adopter of new platforms, will try any new sports app for the sign-up bonus.

Key Demographic Data: 84% of fantasy sports players have a bachelor's degree. 63% earn more than $50,000. The male-to-female ratio is approximately 1.83:1 (64% male, 35% female).

58% of fantasy players fall into the 25-44 age bracket. The NFL is played by 74% of fantasy players, indicating significant overlap with college football interest.

5. Unique Value Proposition

Draft Programs. Not Players.

Rivyls is the only fantasy sports platform where you become the coach, not the statistician. Instead of researching individual player projections, injury reports, and snap counts, you make the same strategic decisions real athletic directors and coaches face: Which programs are built to win? Which conferences are toughest? Which schools are on the rise?

What Makes Rivyls Different

1. Programs, Not Players: You draft Alabama, Oregon, and Texas — not their quarterbacks. Your success rises and falls with the entire program, just like a real coach's legacy. This creates a fundamentally different strategic challenge that rewards deep college sports knowledge.

2. Season-Long Strategy: Unlike daily fantasy where you reset every day, Rivyls rewards the decisions you make before the season and the adjustments you make during it. Add/drop transactions let you respond to surprises — a coaching change, a breakout season, a conference championship contender nobody saw coming.

3. Social Competition: Rivyls is built for friend groups, not anonymous pools. Private leagues with snake drafts, commissioner controls, and season-long rivalries. The trash talk writes itself when your friend drafted a school that just lost to an FCS team.

4. Lower Barrier to Entry: Traditional fantasy football requires knowledge of hundreds of individual players across 32 NFL teams. Rivyls requires knowledge of college programs — something millions of fans already have through school allegiance, conference awareness, and Saturday afternoon viewing habits.

5. Multi-Sport Expandability: The program-drafting model works across any team sport. College basketball, baseball, hockey, soccer, and international sports all have program-level narratives that fans already follow. This is not a single-sport product.

The One-Liner: *"Fantasy sports where you think like a coach, not a calculator."*

6. Marketing & Go-to-Market Strategy

Phase 1: Pre-Season Build (March - August 2026)

Goal: Launch web platform, seed 50-100 leagues, build commissioner pipeline.

Commissioner Acquisition Program: The commissioner is the single most important user to acquire. One commissioner brings an entire league of 8-12 users. Strategy: Identify and recruit 50-100 commissioners through targeted outreach on Reddit (r/CFB, r/fantasyfootball), college sports Discord servers, Twitter/X college football communities, and sports podcast audiences. Offer commissioners a free premium tier for the first season, plus a $10-25 bonus for every full league they launch.

Content Creator Partnerships: Partner with 10-20 college football podcasters, YouTubers, and Twitter/X personalities at the micro-influencer level (5K-50K followers). Budget: $200-500 per creator for a season-long mention deal. These creators have highly engaged, niche audiences that are precisely the Rivyls target market. Larger creators (100K+) can be approached on a performance/affiliate basis.

University Outreach: Target 20-30 universities with active Greek life, sports clubs, and student organizations. Offer free league sponsorships with prizes for the top-performing league at each school. This creates word-of-mouth at the grassroots level and builds brand awareness among the 18-22 demographic that will become lifelong users.

SEO and Content Marketing: Launch a blog and social media presence focused on college football analysis from a program-level perspective: "Which programs are best positioned for 2026?" "Conference power rankings for your Rivyls draft." This content serves dual purposes — SEO acquisition and draft preparation value for users.

Phase 2: In-Season Growth (September - January 2026-27)

Goal: Retain 80%+ of users through the full season; generate organic referrals.

Weekly Engagement Loops: Push notifications and emails for: scoring updates after Saturday games, transaction window reminders, leaderboard changes, and matchup previews. The goal is to make Rivyls a habit tied to the college football Saturday rhythm.

Social Sharing: Make it effortless for users to share draft results, weekly scores, and league standings on social media. Every share is a free acquisition impression. Build shareable "cards" showing draft results and weekly performance.

Mid-Season League Launch: Allow new leagues to start mid-season with adjusted scoring to prevent exploitation. This captures users who hear about the platform after the season begins and want to join immediately.

Phase 3: Off-Season Retention & Expansion (February - August 2027)

Goal: Retain users year-round; expand to NCAA basketball for March Madness.

March Madness Integration: Launch Rivyls for NCAA basketball, timed to the biggest cultural moment in college sports. The program-drafting model is a natural fit for a tournament built

around school identity. This also provides a second engagement peak that reduces seasonal revenue dependency.

Offseason Content: Mock drafts, recruiting analysis from a program perspective, conference preview content, and early rankings keep users engaged between seasons.

Key Marketing Metrics

Metric	Target	Notes
Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC)	$5-15 per user (commissioner channel)	Track by channel; commissioner referrals should be lowest
Commissioner CAC	$25-50 per commissioner	Each commissioner delivers 8-12 users
Effective CAC	$2-5 per user through commissioners	Commissioner CAC / average league size
Lifetime Value (LTV)	$15-60 per user (Year 1 estimate)	Entry fees + premium subscriptions
LTV:CAC Ratio	Target 3:1 minimum	Below 3:1 = unsustainable acquisition
Retention (Season)	Target 80%+ active through full season	Industry average ~60-70%
Viral Coefficient	Target 1.2+ (each user brings 1.2 new users)	Driven by commissioner referrals and social sharing

7. Operational Plan

Technology Stack

The platform is being built as a modern web application designed for scalability, real-time performance, and mobile-first engagement.

Layer	Technology	Rationale
Frontend	React/Next.js (responsive web app, mobile-optimized)	Enables fast development, strong ecosystem, eventual React Native mobile app
Backend / Database	Supabase (PostgreSQL) with real-time subscriptions	Relational data model suits league/team/program structures; real-time for live scoring
Data Integration	ESPN API for live scores, schedules, rankings	Proven integration from MVP; reliable and free tier available
Hosting	Vercel or AWS (frontend); Supabase Cloud (backend)	Scalable, cost-effective at low volumes, enterprise-grade at scale
Authentication	Supabase Auth (email, Google, Apple sign-in)	Reduces friction for signup; supports social login
Payments	Stripe	Industry standard; supports entry fees, subscriptions, payouts

Daily Operations

Pre-Season (March - August): Platform development and testing, content creation, commissioner recruitment, partnership outreach, legal/compliance review, beta testing with existing user base.

In-Season (September - January): Daily: Monitor live scoring systems, respond to user support tickets, moderate community. Weekly: Process scoring updates after Saturday games, open/close transaction windows, publish content (power rankings, analysis). Ongoing: Monitor platform performance, fix bugs, iterate on features based on user feedback.

Off-Season (February - August): Analyze season data for product improvements, develop new features, expand to additional sports, recruit commissioners for next season, prepare marketing materials, update school/program data for upcoming season.

Staffing Plan

Period	Headcount	Roles	Est. Cost
Year 1 (2026)	1 FTE (Founder)	Solo founder handles development, operations, marketing, and support. Contract designers and marketers as needed.	$0 salary (founder sweat equity) + $15K-30K contractor budget

Year 2 (2027)	2-3 FTEs	Hire: 1 full-stack developer, 1 community/marketing manager. Founder shifts to product and strategy.	$150K-250K total compensation
Year 3 (2028)	5-8 FTEs	Add: 1 additional developer, 1 data analyst, 1 customer support, 1 content/social media. Consider fractional CFO.	$400K-650K total compensation

Key Suppliers & Partners

ESPN API: Primary data source for live scores, schedules, and rankings. Free tier is sufficient for early growth. May need to negotiate enterprise access as volume scales.

Stripe: Payment processing for entry fees and subscriptions. Standard 2.9% + $0.30 per transaction.

Supabase: Backend infrastructure. Free tier supports initial development; Pro plan ($25/month) for production. Scales cost-effectively.

Vercel: Frontend hosting. Free tier for development; Pro plan ($20/month) for production with custom domain.

[Add: Legal counsel (gaming/fantasy sports law), accounting firm, insurance provider]

Legal & Regulatory Considerations

Fantasy sports are classified as games of skill in most U.S. states, which provides a more favorable regulatory environment than sports betting. However, compliance varies by state and requires careful attention.

Key considerations: State-by-state fantasy sports regulations and registration requirements, consumer protection and responsible gaming disclosures, payment processing compliance (money transmitter laws in some states), terms of service and privacy policy, age verification (18+ or 21+ depending on jurisdiction), tax implications for prize payouts (1099 reporting for winnings over $600).

[Action Required: Engage a gaming/fantasy sports attorney to review state-by-state compliance requirements before launch]

8. Financial Projections

Note: These projections are illustrative and based on assumptions outlined below. Actual results will depend on user acquisition velocity, conversion rates, and market conditions. All figures should be stress-tested against pessimistic scenarios before use in fundraising materials.

Key Assumptions

Assumption	Value
Average league size	10 users
Paid league entry fee	$20-50 per user per season
Platform rake on paid leagues	10-15% of entry fees
Premium subscription price	$4.99/month or $29.99/year
Free-to-paid conversion rate	15-25% (Year 1: 15%, Year 3: 25%)
Premium subscription conversion	5-10% of active users
Advertising CPM (free tier)	$8-15 CPM
Commissioner referral cost	$25-50 per commissioner
Average user sessions per week (in-season)	3-5
Season length (football)	~18 weeks (August - January)
Churn rate (annual)	30-40% (Year 1), improving to 20-25% by Year 3

3-Year User Growth Projections

Metric	Year 1 (2026-27)	Year 2 (2027-28)	Year 3 (2028-29)
Total Users	1,000	10,000	50,000
Total Leagues	100	1,000	5,000
Sports Covered	1 (CFB)	2 (CFB + CBB)	3-4 (CFB, CBB, + others)
Paid League Users (% of total)	150 (15%)	2,000 (20%)	12,500 (25%)
Premium Subscribers (% of total)	50 (5%)	700 (7%)	5,000 (10%)
Active Seasons per Year	1	2	3+

3-Year Income Statement (Projected)

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
REVENUE			
Paid League Entry Fees (rake)	$4,500	$100,000	$625,000
Premium Subscriptions	$1,500	$20,900	$149,500
Advertising Revenue (free tier)	$1,000	$24,000	$150,000
Sponsorships & Partnerships	$0	$25,000	$100,000
Total Revenue	**$7,000**	**$169,900**	**$1,024,500**
COST OF GOODS SOLD			
Payment Processing (Stripe ~3%)	$135	$3,000	$18,750
Hosting & Infrastructure	$1,200	$6,000	$24,000
Data/API Costs	$0	$2,400	$12,000
Prize Pool Payouts (pass-through)	$0	$0	$0
Total COGS	**$1,335**	**$11,400**	**$54,750**
Gross Profit	**$5,665**	**$158,500**	**$969,750**
Gross Margin	**81%**	**93%**	**95%**
OPERATING EXPENSES			
Salaries & Compensation	$0	$200,000	$500,000
Contractor/Freelance	$25,000	$30,000	$40,000
Marketing & User Acquisition	$15,000	$80,000	$200,000
Legal & Compliance	$5,000	$15,000	$30,000
Software & Tools	$2,400	$6,000	$12,000
Office / Co-working	$0	$6,000	$18,000
Insurance	$1,200	$3,000	$6,000
Miscellaneous	$2,000	$5,000	$10,000
Total Operating Expenses	**$50,600**	**$345,000**	**$816,000**
Net Income (Loss)	**($44,935)**	**($186,500)**	**$153,750**
Cumulative Net Income (Loss)	**($44,935)**	**($231,435)**	**($77,685)**

Startup Costs (Pre-Launch)

Item	Estimated Cost
Legal incorporation & compliance review	$3,000 - $8,000
Domain, branding, logo design	$500 - $2,000
Web platform development (contractor support)	$10,000 - $30,000
Initial marketing & content creation	$5,000 - $10,000
Software subscriptions (first 6 months)	$1,200 - $2,400
Legal counsel (gaming attorney)	$3,000 - $10,000
Insurance (general liability)	$600 - $1,200
Contingency (15%)	$3,500 - $9,500
Total Estimated Startup Costs	**$26,800 - $73,100**

Cash Flow Considerations

Revenue Seasonality: College football runs September through January. With only one sport in Year 1, approximately 80-90% of annual revenue will be concentrated in these 5 months. Adding NCAA basketball in Year 2 extends the revenue window through April, and additional sports in Year 3 further smooths cash flow.

Working Capital: Entry fees are collected before or at the start of the season, creating favorable working capital dynamics. Platform fees are earned immediately upon collection. Prize payouts occur at season end, providing a float period.

Break-Even Analysis: Based on the projections above, Rivyls reaches operational break-even in Year 3 with approximately 50,000 users. Cumulative losses through Year 2 total approximately $231,000, which represents the minimum funding requirement assuming no revenue acceleration or cost reduction.

[Action Required: Build a detailed monthly cash flow model with seasonal adjustments and sensitivity analysis for different growth scenarios (pessimistic: 50% of targets, base: targets as stated, optimistic: 150% of targets)]

9. Funding Requirements

Funding Overview

Rivyls is seeking $250,000 - $500,000 in seed funding to accelerate development and go-to-market execution for the 2026 college football season. The founder is also prepared to bootstrap to initial traction milestones (100 leagues, 1,000 users) and raise based on demonstrated metrics.

Use of Funds

Category	% of Total	Amount	Detail
Product Development	40%	$100K - $200K	Complete web platform, hire contract developers, QA testing
Marketing & User Acquisition	25%	$62.5K - $125K	Commissioner recruitment, creator partnerships, content marketing, university outreach
Operations & Legal	15%	$37.5K - $75K	Legal compliance review, insurance, payment processing setup, gaming attorney
Founder Compensation	10%	$25K - $50K	Modest living expenses to allow full-time commitment
Reserve / Contingency	10%	$25K - $50K	Unexpected costs, opportunity fund

Funding Strategy

Option A: Bootstrap + Angel (Recommended): Self-fund through the 2026 season to demonstrate traction metrics (users, retention, engagement). Then raise a seed round from angel investors or small funds with demonstrated product-market fit. This approach preserves equity and creates leverage in fundraising.

Option B: Pre-Traction Seed Round: Raise $250K-$500K on the strength of the MVP validation, market opportunity, and founder capability. Target fantasy sports-focused angels, sports tech funds, or accelerator programs (Y Combinator, Techstars Sports, etc.).

Option C: Accelerator Program: Apply to sports tech accelerators that provide $100K-$150K in funding plus mentorship, industry connections, and credibility. Programs to consider: Techstars Sports, Stadia Ventures, Sports Innovation Lab.

[Decision Required: Choose funding strategy based on timeline urgency, equity tolerance, and available personal runway]

10. SWOT Analysis

STRENGTHS

- First-mover in program-level fantasy sports — no direct competitor exists
- Validated concept through full-season MVP with real users
- Lower barrier to entry than traditional fantasy (programs vs. players)
- Founder combines deep technical capability with domain expertise
- Proprietary technology built from scratch, not white-label
- Built-in multi-sport expandability (same mechanic works across team sports)
- Social/friend-group model drives organic acquisition through commissioners

WEAKNESSES

- Solo founder — limited bandwidth for simultaneous development, marketing, and operations
- No established brand recognition or marketing budget
- Revenue is highly seasonal (concentrated around football season in Year 1)
- Dependent on ESPN API for data (no alternative currently validated)
- Limited funding limits speed-to-market and marketing reach
- No moat beyond execution speed and community (concept is replicable)

OPPORTUNITIES

- Massive fantasy sports market growing 12-15% annually with $31B+ current value
- College sports engagement at all-time high (CFP expansion, realignment, NIL)
- March Madness expansion creates natural second engagement peak
- Pick'em and simplified fantasy formats growing faster than traditional DFS
- International expansion potential (soccer/football clubs, cricket teams, rugby programs)
- Potential acquisition target for DraftKings, FanDuel, ESPN, or sports media companies
- Partnership opportunities with college sports media (Barstool, 247Sports, On3)

THREATS

- DraftKings, FanDuel, or ESPN could launch a copycat product with massive distribution
- Regulatory changes to fantasy sports classification in key states
- User acquisition costs could exceed projections in competitive attention market
- ESPN could restrict or monetize API access, disrupting data pipeline
- Economic downturn could reduce discretionary spending on fantasy entry fees
- College sports landscape changes (further realignment, NIL impact on program parity) could affect product mechanics

Strategic Takeaway: The central tension in Rivyls' strategy is speed vs. resources. The concept has no defensible IP moat — any well-funded competitor could build a similar product. The moat must be built through execution: being first to market, building community and network effects, establishing brand identity in the category, and creating switching costs through

league history, commissioner tools, and social connections. Every month of delay increases the risk of a well-funded competitor entering the space.

11. Appendix

A. Research & Data Needed

The following items require additional research or decisions to complete this business plan:

1. Legal Structure: Consult with a startup attorney to determine LLC vs. C-Corp, state of incorporation (Delaware recommended for VC track), and operating agreement/bylaws.

2. State-by-State Compliance: Engage a gaming/fantasy sports attorney to map regulatory requirements for each target state. Some states require registration, bonding, or specific consumer protections.

3. Tax Implications: Understand tax obligations for prize payouts (1099-MISC for winnings over $600), state tax withholding requirements, and platform revenue taxation.

4. Insurance: Obtain quotes for general liability, professional liability (E&O), and cyber liability insurance.

5. Detailed Cash Flow Model: Build a month-by-month cash flow projection with seasonal adjustments, sensitivity analysis, and runway calculations.

6. Competitor Deep Dive: Monitor for any announcements of program-level fantasy products from established players. Set Google Alerts for relevant terms.

7. User Research: Conduct structured interviews with 20-30 potential users to validate willingness to pay, preferred features, and pain points with existing products.

8. Pricing Validation: Test different entry fee levels ($10, $20, $50) and subscription prices ($2.99, $4.99, $9.99/month) through surveys or early beta.

B. Key Milestones & Timeline

Target Date	Milestone
March 2026	Complete web platform MVP (core draft, scoring, transactions)
April 2026	Begin beta testing with existing 20-user base
May 2026	Launch commissioner recruitment campaign
June 2026	Begin content creator partnerships; launch social media presence
July 2026	Open platform for public registration; begin university outreach
August 2026	Full platform launch for 2026 college football season
September 2026	First full week of live scoring on web platform
January 2027	End of first web platform season; analyze metrics
February 2027	Begin NCAA basketball development

March 2027	Launch March Madness product
August 2027	Year 2 football season with expanded features
2028	Multi-sport platform; potential Series A preparation

C. Glossary

Commissioner: The user who creates and manages a league. Commissioners invite other users, set league rules, and manage the draft.

Snake Draft: A draft format where the order reverses each round (1-2-3-4, then 4-3-2-1), ensuring fairness regardless of draft position.

Add/Drop Transaction: A mid-season roster move where a user drops one program and adds another, subject to league rules and transaction limits.

Program: A college athletic program (e.g., Alabama Crimson Tide, Oregon Ducks). The draft unit in Rivyls, replacing individual players in traditional fantasy.

Rake: The platform's percentage fee on paid league entry fees. Industry standard ranges from 10-15%.

DFS (Daily Fantasy Sports): Short-duration fantasy contests (typically single-day or single-week) popularized by DraftKings and FanDuel.

CAC (Customer Acquisition Cost): The total cost to acquire one new user, including marketing spend, referral bonuses, and related expenses.

LTV (Lifetime Value): The total revenue a user generates over their entire relationship with the platform.

END OF BUSINESS PLAN

Rivyls — Draft Programs. Not Players.